Shovel



Category: **Hand Tools - Striking & Digging** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 9 labs

Covers these lab items: Shovel; Shovel (Small); Shovels and Specialty Spades; Shovel/Trowel/Bucket

What it is used for

Use a shovel to dig, lift, move, or spread soil, sand, compost, or other suitable loose materials.

How to use

1. Choose a shovel shape and size suitable for the material and task.
2. Inspect the blade, handle, and joint for cracks or looseness.
3. Clear the work area and ensure stable footing.
4. Place the blade into the material and grip the handle firmly with both hands.
5. Use your legs and keep your back as neutral as possible when lifting.
6. Move the material to the designated area without twisting suddenly.
7. Remove dirt from the shovel and store it safely after use.

⚠ Safety

- Wear sturdy footwear and gloves appropriate for the task.
- Do not overload the shovel or lift more than you can manage safely.
- Keep other people clear of the digging and swinging area.
- Check for buried cables, pipes, or other hazards before digging.

Care & storage

- Clean and dry the blade after use to reduce rust.
- Store the shovel securely with the blade protected and the handle supported.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.